COMPETENCY-BASED CURRICULUM FRAMEWORK • COMMON COMPETENCIES

MODULE 6: OPERATING A PERSONAL COMPUTER

CBC-BCL-06
Rev. 00-03/08/17

UNIT OF COMPETENCY
Operate a Personal Computer / Perform Computer Operations

NOMINAL DURATION
2 Hours (Modular / Hands-on)

QUALIFICATION LEVEL
Basic Computer Literacy

Module Descriptor: This module defines the competency required to operate a personal computer by: connecting peripherals, safely starting up and powering down the PC, logging in/out of system environments, navigating operating system controls, organizing files and directories, handling application software, and managing document printing.

SUMMARY OF MODULE LEARNING OUTCOMES:

LO 1	LO 2	LO 3	LO 4	LO 5
Start & Shutdown PC systems	Customize Desktop & Windows	Manage Files & Directories	Operate User Applications	Configure & Print Outputs

LO 1. START AND SHUTDOWN COMPUTERS

COMPETENCY STANDARD 2.1.1

ASSESSMENT CRITERIA	TECHNICAL CONTENTS	CONDITIONS & RESOURCES	METHODOLOGIES	ASSESSMENT
1. Peripheral Setup: Devices correctly connected in compliance with operating manual. **2. Power Initialization:** Main power, UPS/AVR, and system peripherals energized in safe sequence.	• Proper wire, cable, and I/O connections • Power sequence & surge suppressor protocol • POST verification & boot sequence	• Functional PC workstation set • Standard cables (VGA/HDMI/Power) • Peripheral device diagrams • Equipment safety checklist	• Lecture-demonstration • Self-paced learning • Practical drill	• Direct observation • Demonstration of skills • Oral questioning
3. Authentication: Secure logging in and logging off performed according to existing network setup. **4. OS Navigation:** Core OS interface, taskbar, start menu, and system icons accessed accurately.	• User account credentials & login security • OS environment fundamentals • Task navigation & multi-window views	• Individual student user profile • Pre-configured Windows OS • Operating user manuals • Instructional guide sheets	• Hands-on exercise • Guided simulation • Interactive discussion	• Hands-on assessment • Practical performance test • Written quiz
5. System Inspection: Hardware specifications (RAM, CPU, storage) checked via OS properties. **6. Program Termination:** Active applications closed cleanly and open files saved prior to shutdown.	• System properties dialog exploration • Unsaved work warning protocols • Task manager process state review	• PC hardware inventory sheet • Sample multi-window workloads • Diagnostic utility software	• Step-by-step walkthrough • Individual laboratory work	• Direct observation • Skill verification
7. Safe Shutdown: Proper system shutdown, power switch deactivation, and peripheral isolation completed.	• Shutdown vs. Sleep vs. Restart modes • Power sequencing down to peripherals • Workplace ergonomic & safety rules	• PC workstation with AVR/UPS • End-of-class shutdown protocol sheet	• Practical demonstration • Routine reinforcement	• Performance rubric check • Workplace checklist

LO 2. ARRANGE AND CUSTOMIZE DESKTOP / WINDOWS SETTINGS

COMPETENCY STANDARD 2.1.2

ASSESSMENT CRITERIA	TECHNICAL CONTENTS	CONDITIONS & RESOURCES	METHODOLOGIES	ASSESSMENT
1. Desktop Interface: Desktop screen elements, background wallpaper, resolution, and display theme modified to workplace specifications.	• Desktop display settings & resolution • Personalization panel features • Color balance and high-contrast modes	• Workstations with color monitors • Standard operating guidelines • Screen resolution samples	• Interactive lecture • Individual lab drill • Discussion	• Demonstration of skills • Direct observation • Oral questioning
2. Desktop Icon Management: System and application icons added, renamed, moved, auto-arranged, grouped, or deleted accurately.	• Creating and sorting desktop shortcuts • Renaming and deleting shortcut links • Grid alignment and view size options	• Workstation desktop setup • Pre-configured application icons • Practice folder templates	• Guided demonstration • Hands-on manipulation	• Practical performance test • Direct observation
3. Online Help Systems: Windows built-in help and diagnostic search accessed to locate assistance for specific functions.	• Windows Help / Support features • Keyword indexing and query inputs • Contextual help troubleshooting	• Active PC with Help system enabled • Sample troubleshooting tasks • Task requirement cards	• Self-paced tutorial • Problem-solving drill	• Skill execution rubric • Evaluation interview
4. Application Shortcuts & Properties: Desktop icons for core programs opened, pinned to taskbar, inspected for file targets, and exited properly.	• Application target paths & file origins • Pinned items vs. desktop icons • Icon properties dialog examination	• Standard office productivity suite • Windows file explorer • Shortcut property reference guide	• Demonstration • Hands-on practice	• Practical evaluation • Direct questioning
5. Profile Settings Persistence: Customized desktop configuration and windows parameters verified, preserved, and restored to default state.	• Saving user profile appearance settings • Restoring default themes and system font sizes • Workplace shared-workstation etiquette	• Multi-user operating environment • Institutional standard guidelines • Desktop backup/reset sheet	• Group interaction • Practical application	• Direct observation • Demonstration of skills

Key Pedagogical Guidance for LO 2: Emphasize ergonomics and accessibility during desktop configuration. Trainees must understand that customizing display settings (such as text scaling and mouse pointer visibility) serves functional productivity and visual comfort, while shared laboratory workstations must always be restored to standard enterprise configurations at the conclusion of each session.

✓ Display Resolution ✓ Taskbar Pinning ✓ Desktop Shortcuts ✓ Windows Help Utility ✓ Default Theme Restoration

LO 3. WORK WITH FILES AND FOLDERS (OR DIRECTORIES)

COMPETENCY STANDARD 2.1.3

ASSESSMENT CRITERIA	TECHNICAL CONTENTS	CONDITIONS & RESOURCES	METHODOLOGIES	ASSESSMENT
1. Directory Management: Files and hierarchical folders created, opened, renamed, relocated, duplicated, and restored using established naming conventions.	• Directory hierarchy & path structure • File creation, rename, and copy commands • Drag-and-drop vs. clipboard shortcuts (Ctrl+C/X/V) • Recycle Bin restoration procedures	• Windows File Explorer • Structured practice datasets • USB Flash drives / network shared drive • Organizational file naming standard	• Lecture-demonstration • Hands-on laboratory work • Self-paced modules	• Direct observation • Performance skill test • Folder audit
2. Attribute Inspection: Detailed file and folder attributes (file size, extension, modified date, permissions, read-only tag) inspected and verified.	• Properties window tabs & attributes • Identifying file extensions (.docx, .xlsx, .pdf, .txt) • View modes: Details, List, Large Icons	• Varied file-type test library • Workstation with file viewing tools • Attribute identification guide	• Guided discovery • Individual practice drill	• Oral questioning • Practical identification
3. Logical Organization: Disorganized files categorized systematically into subdirectories based on subject, date, project, or department.	• Filing logic and taxonomy best practices • Organizing document archives • Sorting by name, date modified, type, size	• Simulated unsorted document pool • Departmental organization rubric • Workstation storage access	• Problem-based scenario • Hands-on exercise	• Direct observation • Practical performance
4. Information Search: Windows search bar and wildcards utilized to rapidly locate misplaced documents and system assets.	• Search syntax and wildcard parameters (*, ?) • Filtering results by date range and file kind • Content-based indexing search	• Local drive with nested subfolders • Search scenario task sheets • Instructional search manual	• Timed laboratory drill • Group discussion	• Practical test • Demonstration of skills
5. Removable Media Care: Removable drives inspected for free capacity, scanned for integrity, safely mounted, and properly ejected.	• Storage capacity calculation (KB, MB, GB) • Disk formatting warnings & file systems (FAT32/NTFS) • "Safely Remove Hardware" protocol	• USB Flash drives / external storage • Storage management utilities • Safe hardware removal checklist	• Demonstration • Hands-on simulation	• Demonstration checklist • Direct observation

Data Integrity & Safe Media Protocols: Trainees must strictly adhere to the "Safely Remove Hardware and Eject Media" operating procedure before disconnecting USB drives. Sudden disconnection without unmounting corrupts file allocation tables and risks catastrophic loss of trainee project files.

✓ Directory Tree ✓ File Extensions ✓ Recycle Bin Recovery ✓ Wildcard Search (*.pdf) ✓ Safe USB Ejection

LO 4. WORK WITH USER APPLICATION PROGRAMS

COMPETENCY STANDARD 2.1.4

ASSESSMENT CRITERIA	TECHNICAL CONTENTS	CONDITIONS & RESOURCES	METHODOLOGIES	ASSESSMENT
1. Program Execution: Applications launched via Start Menu, shortcuts, or run commands; window controls (minimize, maximize, restore, close) utilized smoothly.	• Application launching channels • Multitasking with Alt+Tab • Window sizing and split-screen docking	• Workstations with standard productivity apps • Operating manuals & quick references	• Demonstration • Hands-on practice	• Direct observation • Skills demonstration
2. Software Maintenance: Software application status, installed version numbers, and update availability checked per manual procedure.	• Installed apps & features list • Software versioning numbers • Safe software updating fundamentals	• Settings / Control Panel access • Enterprise style guide / software policy	• Lecture-demonstration • Self-paced drill	• Written examination • Performance test
3. Cross-App Data Exchange: Text, images, and data transferred seamlessly between different active applications via clipboard functions.	• Windows Clipboard operations • Copy, cut, and paste formats • Import/export text & images	• Word processor, spreadsheet, and paint tools • Practice data transfer tasks	• Hands-on application • Practical drill	• Practical performance • Output evaluation

LO 5. PRINT INFORMATION

COMPETENCY STANDARD 2.1.5

ASSESSMENT CRITERIA	TECHNICAL CONTENTS	CONDITIONS & RESOURCES	METHODOLOGIES	ASSESSMENT
1. Printer Selection: Target network or local printer installed, selected, and assigned as default printer according to workstation environment.	• Local USB vs. Network printer setup • Setting default system printer • Verifying printer status (Online/Ready)	• Network-connected or local printer • Printer drivers / installer media • Connection cables / LAN setup	• Lecture-demonstration • Individual hands-on drill	• Demonstration of skills • Direct observation
2. Page Setup & Execution: Paper size (Letter/A4), orientation (Portrait/Landscape), margins, and print preview inspected before sending output.	• Page setup dialog parameters • Print Preview inspection to avoid waste • Page range and copy count adjustments	• Pre-formatted practice documents • Standard paper stock • Printer loaded with consumables	• Demonstration • Practical printing drill	• Output quality evaluation • Hands-on observation
3. Print Spooler Control: Active print jobs inspected via print queue; stuck or unneeded print spooler tasks paused, restarted, or deleted.	• Accessing the Windows print spooler queue • Managing pending print jobs • Canceling erroneous print requests	• Live print queue environment • Sample multi-page print tasks • Printer operational guide	• Guided simulation • Interactive troubleshooting	• Practical performance • Oral questioning

Institutional Verification & Competency Sign-Off: Completion of Module 6 certifies that the student has demonstrated independent capability in basic computer initialization, system customization, structured file management, multitasking across applications, and document printing in accordance with TESDA competency standards.